

词汇: *time* 时间

- 1 Close your eyes and think about the future. Do you imagine it to be in front of you or behind you? Maybe your **timeline** is **vertical**, with the future below, and the past above? Linguists such as Lera Boroditsky believe that the language you speak might influence your perception of time.
- 2 She highlighted that in English, we see time on a **horizontal** line. The past is behind us, and the future is ahead. We can see this in phrases like '**forward thinking**', and '**ahead of schedule**' that we use for the future, and '**back in the day**' and '**behind the times**' for the past. However, not all languages reflect this perspective.
- 3 For the Aymara people in the Andes mountains, the word for future means 'behind time'. Work by Nuñez and Sweetser revealed that when gesturing, the Aymara people point **backwards** when talking about the future, while English speakers gesture **forwards**. It has also been suggested that if you speak Chinese, you might see the timeline more **vertically** due to the use of 'down' to talk about future events, and 'up' for past events.
- 4 What happens if you speak two languages? In a study called 'Can a mind have two time lines?' English-Chinese bilinguals were asked to place photos of actors in **chronological order** by age. Interestingly, they chose to put photos of an English-speaking actor in a horizontal **sequence**, but photos of a Chinese-speaking actor in a vertical sequence. So, it seems like one person can have multiple **time perceptions**, and that your timeline can rotate depending on which language is in focus.
- 5 The debate about how much language shapes our thoughts and perceptions is **ongoing**. It has intrigued linguists for **decades** and will for **ages** to come. So, next time you plan your day or tell a story, notice how you visualise the timeline of events, and remember that not everyone sees time through the same lens!

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. English phrases
- b. An unfinished argument
- c. How do you perceive time?
- d. One mind, two time perceptions?
- e. Lie horizontally to imagine time
- f. Time perceptions of speakers of different languages

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. What does the phrase 'forward thinking' suggest about English speakers?
 - a. They imagine the future to be in front of them.
 - b. They imagine the future to be above them.
 - c. They find it hard to imagine the future.
2. What does 'this' refer to in the following sentence? *We can see this in phrases like 'forward thinking', and 'ahead of schedule' that we use for the future, and 'back in the day' and 'behind the times' for the past.*
 - a. English
 - b. English-speakers' time perception
 - c. the future
3. The Aymara word for future indicates that Aymara people perceive the future to be behind them.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. Bilingual people may see time in multiple ways.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

5. Linguists think this debate is...
- a. problematic.
 - b. complicated.
 - c. interesting.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Have you ever thought about how you imagine a **1)** _____ of events? When you put events in **2)** _____, do you imagine them in a vertical or **3)** _____ line? The language we use can give clues about our **4)** _____. For example, phrases in English like 'back in the day' suggest we may look **5)** _____ to our past.

vertically	horizontal	backwards
sequence		chronological order
time perception		ahead of schedule

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

timeline	时间轴
vertical	垂直的
horizontal	水平的，与地面平行的
forward thinking	前瞻性思维，有前瞻性的
ahead of schedule	提前
back in the day	从前，曾几何时
behind the times	过时，落伍
backwards	向后
forwards	向前
vertically	垂直地
chronological order	按时间先后顺序排列
sequence	顺序，序列
time perception	时间感知
ongoing	仍在进行的，持续存在的
decade	十年
ages	很长时间

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **c) How do you perceive time?**

Paragraph 2 **a) English phrases**

Paragraph 3 **f) Time perceptions of speakers of different languages**

Paragraph 4 **d) One mind, two time perceptions?**

Paragraph 5 **b) An unfinished argument**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a.** ...*in English, we see time on a horizontal line. The past is behind us, and **the future is ahead. We can see this in phrases like 'forward thinking', and 'ahead of schedule' that we use for the future.***
2. **b.** The pronoun 'this' refers to the sentence '*In English, we see time on a **horizontal** line*', which, in summary, is English speakers' time perception.
3. **a. True.** *For the Aymara people in the Andes mountains, the word for future means '**behind** time'. ...when gesturing, the Aymara people point **backwards** when talking about the future.*
4. **a. True.** *Interestingly, they [bilinguals] chose to put photos of an English-speaking actor in a horizontal sequence, but photos of a Chinese-speaking actor in a vertical sequence. So, it seems like **one person can have multiple time perceptions.***
5. **c.** *It [the debate] has **intrigued** linguists for decades and will for ages to come.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Have you ever thought about how you imagine a **sequence** of events? When you put events in **chronological order**, do you imagine them in a vertical or **horizontal** line? The language we use can give clues about our **time perception**. For example, phrases in English like 'back in the day' suggest we may look **backwards** to our past.